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(1) Research Program/Project/Study Title: Ethical Climate in Capiz State University:Its Influence on Rule Bending	
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Program or Project has component (if no proceed to 2)? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Component Title:	
Component Leader:	
Academic Rank:	

(2) Category (please check) ☒ Social Science/Education /Humanities & other related fields ☐ Natural/BiologicalSciences ☐ Food Research/ ☐ Developmental/ Computer/Engineering/ Architecture ☐ Extension ☐ Poster	(3) Research Center [Check the concerned center] ☒ SSITRDC Social Science and Industrial Technology Research Development Center ☐ LRDC Livestock Research Development Center ☐ FFRDC Fisheries and Food Research Development Center ☐ CSRDC Crop Science Research Development Center
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(4) Site of implementation							
Municipality/City:							
Province: Capiz							
Region: VI							
(5) Classification <table> <tr> <td>Research:</td> <td>Development:</td> </tr> <tr> <td>☐ Basic</td> <td>☐ Pilot Testing</td> </tr> <tr> <td>☐ Applied</td> <td>☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization</td> </tr> </table>	Research:	Development:	☐ Basic	☐ Pilot Testing	☐ Applied	☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization	(6) Mode of Implementation ☐ Single Authorship/Proponent ☐ Collaborative Research (within campus) ☒ Collaborative Research (intercampus) ☐ Collaborative Research (external agency)
Research:	Development:						
☐ Basic	☐ Pilot Testing						
☐ Applied	☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization						

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(7) Sector/Commodity	(8) Discipline/Field of Specialization
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(9A) Abstract (This has a maximum of 250 words. It contains 1-2 sentences of rationale, followed by objectives, brief methodology, major findings, and implications of impact of the study.)

The study was conducted at Capiz State University during academic year 2021-2022. Primarily the study aimed to determine the ethical climate and extent of practices of faculty and staff of CapSU and its relationship to rule bending. Data were analyzed using both descriptive statistics and inferential statistics. Results were interpreted at 5 percent alpha level of significance. As to the personal characteristics of the respondents, a bigger percentage of the respondents belonged to the academic staff, females and 31-40 years old, married. Generally, the respondents have a higher level of code and law climate but lower level of personal morality climate. A positive correlation (0.051) exists between personal morality and rule bending of the respondents. Moreover, negative correlation (-0.199) was found between the level of code and law climate and rule bending. This implies that employees of Capiz State University look to government rules or professional conventions to resolve dilemmas ethically. While in personal morality is found to be a significant relationship to rule bending behavior. This implies that employees tend to bend rule as they may be more important to someone than the values of the organization.

(9B) Keywords (Write 3-6 words you used in the study, preferably not found in the title because words in the title are already given keywords. This would also include process, or methodology employed.)

Keywords: rule bending, ethical climate

(10) Introduction (This includes the rationale, background of the study, and objectives which are not divided by subheadings. Incorporate at least three (3) reviews)

There is no doubt that organizations worldwide are striving for success and out-competing those in the same industry. In order to do so, organizations have to obtain and utilize her human resources effectively. Organizations need to be aware of face more realistically towards keeping their human resources up-to-date. In so doing, managers need to pay special attention to all the core functions of human resource management as this plays an important role in different organizational, social and economically related areas among others that are influential to the attainment of the organizational goals and thus organizations successful continuation in the market.

Most administrators live by a personal code of conduct that includes certain principles about integrity, regard for others, and keeping commitments. They refrain from engaging in actions that might compromise their reputations, careers, or organizations; they comply with regulations and are law-abiding. Most also believe they are ethical, and that is precisely why, when confronted with situations that they believe compel them to bend company rules, they are decidedly torn. While playing by the rules is the principled thing to do, and many would say the safest too, many managers also feel a responsibility to challenge the rules, because the rules are not always infallible, and fairness to other parties may demand nothing less.

Rules permeate all organizations: 'Even at the most basic level, employees enter and leave their workplaces following the rules specified in the time schedule' (Zhou 1993, p. 1134). Brewer and Walker (2010, p. 418) defined rules as 'norms, regulations, procedures and expectations that regulate individual behaviour in organizations which help to ensure accountability, equity, and ethical behaviour'.

After years of research on how public employees are constrained by rules (see e.g. Merton, 1940; Thompson, 1977; Bozeman and Rainey, 1998), public management scholars have begun to focus on how and why public employees bend rules. At the individual level, such behavior is found to be influenced by one's prudential judgment (Sekerka and Zolin, 2007), degree of nonconformity, public service commitment, risk propensity (DeHart-Davis, 2007), and gender (Portillo and DeHart-Davis,

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2009). Organizational centralization and formalization (DeHart-Davis, 2007) and rule characteristics (DeHart-Davis, 2009) are also found to impact rule bending. While this research explores both individual and organizational influences on rule bending behavior, it has placed more emphasis on the former and less on the latter.

These 'behavioural requirements' suggest that rules beget action, typically in the form of implementation or enforcement, and such action may lead to consequences. Pugh (1966,p. 239) argued that scholars must pay attention to the 'attitudes, values, and goals of specialist subunits and individuals and the way in which these continuously modify the organization's formal structure. Given that individuals develop attitudes about rules, rules require action, and together these may contribute to informal ways of dealing with rules, one might wonder: are these rules actually resulting in desired behaviours? One possible undesired behaviour or unintended consequence is rule bending.

Organizational ethical climate refers to the moral atmosphere of the work environment and the level of ethics practiced within a company. Instrumental, caring, law and order, rules, and independence are the five types of ethical climate that can exist in an organization. Incivility, harassment, aggression, and discrimination can all produce an unethical and hostile work environment, which can create dissatisfied employees, while a positive ethical environment can make employees more productive and even happier.

An ethical climate in an organization consists of the, by the organizational members, "shared perceptions of what is ethically correct behavior and how ethical issues should be handled (Victor and Cullen 1987). It thus essentially refers to the general agreements among members of the organization about what organizational practices and procedures actually mean in terms of expected ethical behavior. (Vidaher-Cohen)

This study aims to determine the following: What are the ethical climate in Capiz State University, what is the extent of practice of rule bending of employees of Capiz State University and is there a significant relationship between ethical climate and rule bending.

(11) Materials and Methods or Methodology (This includes the materials, methods,duration & location of the study. Materials and Methods are headings used in Natural Science researches and methodology is Social Sciences. Presentation of materials may not necessarily be in separate heading but may be incorporated in the specific methods used. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.)

This study utilized descriptive-inferential research. The use of this research design was considered appropriate given the view of the nature of this research that seeks to determine the ethical climate and extent of practice of rule bending among the faculty and staff of the CapSU System and its relationship.

The study was conducted at Capiz State University, Mambusao Satellite College. The respondents of the study were the 254 randomly selected faculty and staff from the different campuses/colleges.

The questionnaire was consisted of 39 items in a variety of formats: Section I consisted of demographic data of the respondents (age, gender, position, no of years in service, status in the organizational ladder). Section II contained 36 items questions on ethical climate. Section III was contained 3 items on rule bending. Responses was determined on a 5-point scale as to: 5=Completely true, 4= Mostly true, 3= Neutral, 2= Somewhat false and 1= Mostly false.

The Ethical Climate Questionnaire was 36-item instrument developed by Victor and Cullen. The scale was comprised of two dimensions assessing ethical climate: (1) Personal morality and (2) Laws and Professional code. Rule Bending was measured by 3 survey item from DeHart Davis. Responses was determined on a 5 point scale ranging to: 5 = Always, 4 = Often, 3 = Neutral, 2 = Occasionally, 1 = Never.

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The data was analyzed using the following statistical tools: frequency counts, means, standard deviation and Pearsons R. The description of ethical climate and rule bending was determined by frequency count, mean and standard deviation. The question of significant relationship between ethical climate and rule bending was computed using Pearsons R. Level of significance was set at 0.5 alpha level.

(12) Results and Discussions (This part contains presentation of results (data) with reference to the table and figure, to be followed by discussion, with support of reviewed literature. Sequence shall be based on the objectives of the study. Tables are formatted without the vertical lines. Horizontal lines are set at the top and bottom portions as well as below table headings and above major subdivisions. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.)

More than two-thirds or 74.80 percent of the respondents were females and the rest (25.80%) were males. Females have higher levels of ethical climate in their workplace. It was found out that women are more likely to abide by rules and less likely to bend them. Perhaps, due to faculty and staff of CapSU in terms of number and status in the organization dominated by females.

When it comes to age, majority (44.49%) were 31-40 years old; 28.74 percent, 41-50 years old; 14.17 percent, 20-30 years old; and 12.60 percent, 51 years old and above. On the average, the respondents included in the study were 40 years old. It can be inferred that most of the faculty and staff of CapSU belonged to young adulthood stage. The result shows that, 41 years old and above have higher levels of law and code climate. This implies that older employees may have been with the institution longer than younger employees. Thus, giving them more familiarity with professional standards and laws. However, opposite with the personal morality climate that older employees perceive a lower levels. Older employees holds a manager or supervisory position, they are likely want their employees to abide by procedures, making it easier to hold them accountable as well as want consistency in implementation.

Most or 70.50 percent of the respondents were faculty members and the rest (29.50%) were non-academic personnel. This shows that the faculty members dominated the working force of the institution. Faculty members show higher levels of ethical climate this may explain that value might be placed on the guidance of professional codes and organizational law when deciding ethical dilemma.

As regression coefficients: -0.199 for the law and code climate and 0.051 for the personal morality climate that law and code climate have a significant negative relationship with rule bending. This implies that employees of Capiz State University look to government rules or professional conventions to resolve dilemmas ethically. While in personal morality is found to be a significant relationship to rule bending behavior. This implies that employees tend to bend rule as they may be more important to someone than the values of the organization.

(13) Conclusions and Recommendations (This part shall be written in narrative form and arranged based on the objectives and findings. Conclusions are general statements answering the objectives. Recommendations are based on the conclusions. They may be split or combined based on their length, which means, conclusions and recommendations may be split under separate headings if they are long. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.)

Conclusions

Based the on findings of the study, the researchers have come up with the following conclusions:

1. This study found out, that the law and code climate is negatively correlated to rule bending of employees. CapSU as a government institution, generally have strong rules and law-and-code climates because of activities that are often constrained by outside sources such as national laws, executive orders and professional associations.

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- This study found out, that personal morality is significantly related to rule bending. Rule bending in the institution may occur for various reasons because of the need to help clients that are considered deserving or worthy, the need to perform jobs or because of personal value conflicts.

Recommendations

The conclusion drawn from the findings of the study served as basis for the following recommendations.

- The result of a negative relationship of law and code climate to rule bending. It is recommended to continue the emphasis on values or importance of rules and regulations as well as professional codes for employees practices within the organization.
- The result of positive relationship of personal morality climate to rule bending. This calls for greater flexibility and emphasis on the citizen's charter because it might lead to greater rule bending behaviors of employees. It might help or influence to curb or less willingness to rule bending behavior of every employee.
- Further studies should consider more than one organizational context or including a way to distinguish between work groups or organizational departments. Since, ethical climates would have greater impact on rule bending because it varies from organization to organization.
- Other variables should be explored in further research to substantiate the relationship between ethical climate of an organization to rule bending.

(14) Output (Indicate the specific products, processes or services which the project has produced; quantify when possible.)

(15) Technology Transfer Activity Conducted (Indicate the specific products, activity design, processes or services transferred as extension activities)

(16) Economic Analysis (This should present the direct cost of project implementation, expenses in the production of technology, revenues generated from technology produced, return on investment (ROI) and payback period.

(17) Acknowledgments (Include only important persons and institutions with involvement in funding and conduct of the research. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.)

(18) References (It should include only works mentioned in the text and should be arranged alphabetically. Citations shall not be less than 13 entries. This must follow the APA latest edition format, in hanging indention with 12-point space in between.)

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